ESSENTIAL FACTS

Date of Birth
June 21, 1983

Place of Birth
Elizabeth City, North Carolina

Parents
Lon and Wendy Snowden

Education
Arundel High School
Anne Arundel Community College

Career Highlights
Snowden was awarded the Sam Adams Award for integrity in intelligence in 2013. Also in 2013, he was named the *Guardian* newspaper's Person of the Year, awarded the German Whistleblower Prize, and received first place in the *Foreign Policy* list of leading global thinkers. Snowden was nominated for the Nobel Peace Prize in 2014.

Societal Contribution
The top-secret documents that Snowden retrieved while working as an employee of two NSA contractors revealed US and foreign surveillance by the NSA on a massive scale. The leaks sparked a global debate about privacy rights versus the need for national security, and they resulted in congressional legislation to place more limits on unwarranted

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